

THE LUXURY

# Travel Planning Guide

An insider roadmap to planning an extraordinary trip — from a boutique agency that does this every day.

DESTINARA TRAVEL

## WELCOME

# Let's plan something extraordinary

Thank you for downloading our planning guide. We're Jay & Elizabeth Nichols, the husband-and-wife team behind Destinara Travel, a boutique luxury agency in Greensboro, NC. This short guide distills how we plan unforgettable trips — so yours starts off right, whether you work with us or not.

## 5 Reasons to Plan With an Advisor

- **Access & perks.** Room upgrades, resort credits, free breakfast, and VIP treatment you can't book online.
- **Time saved.** We do the research, comparison, and coordination — you skip the dozens of open tabs.

- **Insider knowledge.** The right hotel, the right room, the right season, the right guide.
- **One point of contact.** Flights, hotels, transfers, tours — handled, and someone to call if plans change.
- **It's our relationships.** Years of supplier partnerships work in your favor, usually at no extra cost.

STEP BY STEP

# Your Planning Timeline

Great trips reward early planning — the best villas, suites, and guides book out far in advance. Here's a rough roadmap:

| When           | What to do                                                                                          |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 12+ months out | Dream & set a budget. Lock dates and big-ticket items (safaris, holiday weeks, peak-season Europe). |
| 9–12 months    | Book flights/cruise & flagship hotels. Reserve marquee experiences and hard-to-get tables.          |

|                   |                                                                                 |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>6–9 months</b> | Build the day-by-day. Tours, transfers, and special celebrations come together. |
| <b>3–6 months</b> | Confirm details, travel protection, and any visas/vaccinations.                 |
| <b>1 month</b>    | Final documents, packing, and a trip briefing. Then — bon voyage.               |

TIMING IS EVERYTHING

## When to Go: A Quick Guide

| Region               | Sweet spot   | Notes                                      |
|----------------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Caribbean / Mexico   | Dec–Apr      | Dry, warm; book holidays early.            |
| Europe               | May–Jun, Sep | Great weather, fewer crowds than July/Aug. |
| Mediterranean cruise | May, Sep–Oct | Mild & uncrowded shoulder season.          |

|                                |                             |                                 |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>African safari</b>          | <b>Jun–Oct</b>              | Dry season = best game viewing. |
| <b>Maldives / Indian Ocean</b> | <b>Nov–Apr</b>              | Sunny, calm seas.               |
| <b>Japan</b>                   | <b>Mar–Apr,<br/>Oct–Nov</b> | Cherry blossoms / autumn color. |
| <b>Alaska</b>                  | <b>Jun–Aug</b>              | Long days, peak wildlife.       |

## Packing Essentials (Luxury Edition)

- Passport valid 6+ months, plus digital & paper copies
- Universal adapter & portable charger
- One dressier outfit (many fine restaurants have codes)
- Comfortable, broken-in walking shoes
- Compact daypack & reusable water bottle
- Medications in carry-on + a small first-aid kit
- Travel protection documents & our 24/7 contact card



READY WHEN YOU ARE

## Let's Plan Your Trip

This guide only scratches the surface. The real magic is in the details we tailor to you — and our consultation is always complimentary.

**Book a free consultation:** [destinaratravel.com/consultation.html](https://destinaratravel.com/consultation.html)

**Call or text:** (919) 348-6268

**Email:** [info@destinaratravel.com](mailto:info@destinaratravel.com)

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